

ZAYNAB SHUMAN

Senior Programme Quality, MEAL and Adaptive Management Specialist
12+ Years in Humanitarian & Development Sector

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Senior Programme Quality and MEAL professional with 12+ years of experience leading monitoring, evaluation, accountability, learning, adaptive management, and programme quality systems across humanitarian, resilience, and development programmes in the MENA region. Proven experience supporting multi-sector and multi-partner portfolios funded by FCDO, USAID, EU, OCHA, DFID, BMZ, UNICEF, and WFP across complex emergency settings.

Experienced in consortium coordination, strategic planning, donor compliance, evaluations, accountability systems, evidence generation, and cross-functional programme leadership. Extensive experience collaborating with INGOs, UN agencies, consortium partners, and local organizations including CARE International, Relief International, WFP, FAO, DRC, and the Lebanese Red Cross to strengthen programme quality, accountability, adaptive management, and evidence-based decision-making.

Core competencies:

- Programme Quality & Strategic Advisory
- Strategic Programme Planning & Adaptive Management
- Results-Based Management (RBM) & Evidence Use
- MEAL Systems, Evaluations & Learning
- Cross-Sectoral Humanitarian & Resilience Programming
- Partnership, Consortium & Stakeholder Coordination
- Business Development, Proposal Design & Resource Mobilization
- Donor Compliance, Reporting & Grants Management
- Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP)
- Knowledge Management & Organizational Learning
- Capacity Strengthening, Training & Mentorship
- Data Analysis, Visualization & Information Management
- Strategic Communications & Analytical Reporting

Key Donors & Partners

FCDO, DFID, USAID, ECHO, European Union, OCHA, BMZ, UNICEF, WFP, FAO, UNHCR, GIZ, SDC, ADH, CARE International, Relief International, Danish Refugee Council, Lebanese Red Cross, IRC, Mercy Corps, local NGOs, and multi-partner consortium structures.

Regional Experience

Lebanon, Syria response, Jordan-based Syria operations, remote support to humanitarian, resilience, displacement, and conflict-affected contexts across the MENA region.

Sector Experience

Food Security | Cash Assistance | Education | Protection | Health | Resilience | WASH | Emergency Response | Accountability | Community-Based Programming

WORK EXPERIENCE

MEL Lead (Consortium) – CARE Syria | Jordan Office / Remote

Aug 2024 – Mar 2026

- Led consortium-wide MEAL, programme quality, and adaptive management systems for the FCDO-funded Syria Resilience Initiative across multiple operational hubs and partners in complex humanitarian settings.
- Harmonized indicators, reporting systems, and learning approaches across consortium structures, strengthening accountability, reporting consistency, and evidence-based decision-making.
- Directed monitoring, evaluation, third-party monitoring (TPM), and learning processes across consortium partners, ensuring methodological rigor, data verification, donor compliance, corrective action follow-up, and actionable programme insights for adaptive management and operational decision-making.
- Directed the SRI MEAL Working Group, aligning indicators, tools, and evidence-use practices across consortium partners to strengthen accountability to affected populations and shared learning.
- Facilitated cross-functional coordination between programme, grants, operations, and partner teams to improve programme coherence, strategic adaptation, and reporting alignment.
- Led quarterly performance reviews, after-action reviews, and learning processes that informed programme adaptation and operational decision-making across resilience, protection, and education interventions.
- Advised senior leadership on programme performance, operational risks, and evidence-driven strategic adaptation while supporting partner capacity strengthening on RBM, programme quality, and evidence use.

Country MEAL Manager – Relief International | Lebanon | Beirut

Jul 2023 – Aug 2024

- Led the strategic redesign and implementation of country-level MEAL and programme quality systems across humanitarian and development programmes in Lebanon.
- Institutionalized MEAL frameworks aligned with CHS, Sphere, USAID/BHA, and WFP requirements, strengthening accountability, evidence use, and programme quality across multi-sector programming.
- Directed baseline assessments, post-distribution monitoring (PDMs), evaluations, and monitoring processes, improving data quality, donor compliance, and evidence-based programme adaptation.
- Coordinated third-party monitoring (TPM), data verification, and quality assurance processes to strengthen donor compliance, accountability, programme oversight, and evidence-based reporting across multi-sector interventions.
- Strengthened accountability to affected populations through enhancement of feedback and complaint mechanisms integrated into programme decision-making and operational processes.
- Supported proposal development, donor reporting, and strategic planning through indicator design, results frameworks, data analysis, and evidence generation.
- Managed and mentored 6 MEAL staff while strengthening organizational learning, cross-team collaboration, and results-based management practices across programme teams.
- Facilitated trainings and coaching sessions on programme quality, accountability, RBM, and evidence use for MEAL and programme staff.

MEAL Manager – CARE International | Lebanon | Beirut

Nov 2022 – Jul 2023

- Led the redesign and institutionalization of CARE Lebanon's country-level MEAL and programme quality framework across humanitarian and development programming, strengthening evidence-based planning, accountability, and adaptive management processes.
- Established and operationalized standardized MEAL systems, tools, and protocols aligned with CARE global standards, CHS commitments, and donor compliance requirements.
- Directed complex mixed-method evaluations and assessments, including BMZ, ADH, MSNA, and Municipal Preparedness Risk Assessments, generating strategic evidence for programme improvement, donor accountability, and operational planning.
- Integrated MEAL approaches into proposal development, logical frameworks, budgeting, donor reporting, and programme design processes in collaboration with programme and grants teams.
- Strengthened accountability to affected populations and safeguarding integration through oversight of complaint and feedback mechanisms aligned with CHS standards and organizational commitments.
- Supported programme teams in using monitoring findings, evaluation results, and learning processes to inform programme adaptation, risk mitigation, and implementation improvements across sectors.
- Led organizational learning and knowledge management processes through analytical reporting, lessons learned documentation, and facilitation of reflection and learning sessions.
- Managed and mentored a team of 8 MEAL staff while leading capacity strengthening initiatives for CARE and partner teams, improving data quality, results-based management practices, and evidence use across programmes.
- Coordinated with technical, operations, and partner teams to strengthen programme coherence, reporting consistency, and alignment with donor requirements and strategic priorities.

Senior PMEAL Officer / Programme Coordinator – Lebanese Red Cross | Lebanon | Beirut

Jul 2020 – Oct 2022

- Supported programme quality, monitoring, accountability, and operational coordination across humanitarian and resilience programmes implemented in complex emergency settings and in partnership with national and international actors.
- Coordinated and provided technical oversight to 6 sector MEAL coordinators across multi-sector interventions, strengthening implementation tracking, reporting consistency, and results-based management practices.
- Led data collection, analysis, and interpretation processes to support evidence-based decision-making, programme adaptation, operational planning, and donor reporting.
- Supported the design and implementation of assessments, evaluations, accountability mechanisms, and learning processes to strengthen programme quality and responsiveness to community needs.
- Facilitated coordination between programme, operations, field teams, and external stakeholders to address implementation gaps, operational risks, and strengthen emergency response continuity.
- Contributed to organizational learning and knowledge management through analytical reporting, lessons learned exercises, and documentation of programme achievements and operational challenges.
- Supported capacity strengthening initiatives for staff and volunteers through training and technical support on MEAL systems, accountability, data quality, and reporting practices.

MEAL Officer – World Food Programme (WFP) | Lebanon | Zahle

Dec 2014 – Sep 2019

- Supported monitoring, reporting, accountability, and programme coordination functions within large-scale humanitarian cash-based and food assistance programmes implemented across Lebanon.

- Coordinated monitoring, data verification, and reporting processes with field teams, cooperating partners, and implementing partners including INTERSOS, ACF, World Vision, and Mercy Corps, strengthening data quality, operational coordination, and reporting consistency across humanitarian interventions.
- Led analysis and interpretation of monitoring data, post-distribution monitoring (PDM), and programme performance information to support evidence-based operational decision-making and donor reporting.
- Contributed to the development of analytical reports, dashboards, operational updates, and information products used for programme management, coordination, and strategic planning.
- Supported accountability and feedback mechanisms that strengthened community engagement, responsiveness to beneficiary concerns, and programme adaptation within large-scale humanitarian operations.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams and external stakeholders to support operational coordination, assessments, monitoring activities, and information sharing across humanitarian interventions.
- Contributed to organizational learning and knowledge management through lessons learned documentation, reporting tools, and programme performance analysis.

Reporting & Communication Officer / Donor Relations – Danish Refugee Council (DRC) | Lebanon | Zahle

Apr 2014 – Nov 2014

- Led the preparation of donor reports, visibility materials, briefing notes, and evidence-based communication products for humanitarian programmes implemented across Lebanon.
- Synthesized field monitoring findings, programme data, and operational updates into analytical reports and communication materials supporting donor engagement, advocacy, and programme visibility.
- Supported proposal development and donor compliance processes by aligning programme data, logical frameworks, indicators, and reporting requirements for donors including WFP, DFID, and UNICEF.
- Strengthened reporting consistency and information management processes between field teams and country office operations through improved documentation, data consolidation, and reporting workflows.
- Coordinated closely with programme, technical, and field teams to improve the quality, accuracy, and strategic positioning of donor reporting and knowledge management products.
- Supported donor accountability and external communication efforts through timely and strategically tailored reporting outputs for institutional donors and humanitarian stakeholders.

MEAL Coordinator – Beyond Association | Lebanon | Zahle

Jul 2013 – Mar 2014

- Led the MEAL function for non-formal education programmes implemented across 15 education centers in Lebanon, supporting programme quality, accountability, and evidence-based decision-making.
- Designed and operationalized the organization's first formal MEAL framework, including indicators, monitoring tools, data collection systems, and reporting mechanisms aligned with programme objectives and donor requirements.
- Conducted needs assessments, baseline studies, and data analysis processes to inform programme design, targeting approaches, and operational planning.
- Monitored programme quality and learning outcomes through structured classroom observations, teacher evaluations, and performance tracking systems across a network of 55 teachers and education staff.
- Facilitated MEAL and accountability trainings for education staff, strengthening results-based management practices, learner-centered approaches, and evidence use across programmes.
- Contributed to organizational learning and programme adaptation through analytical reporting, lessons learned documentation, and evidence-based recommendations for programme improvement.

Early Career Summary – Education Leadership & Coordination Roles | Lebanon

Aug 2002 – Jun 2013

Held progressive leadership, coordination, and teaching roles across multiple education institutions, building foundational expertise in performance management, team supervision, training, and results-driven learning approaches that later informed humanitarian MEAL and programme quality leadership.

- Coordinated academic planning, teacher supervision, and classroom performance management across multiple private education institutions in Beirut and Baalbeck.
- Led English language education programmes across multiple grade levels, supporting curriculum development, student performance tracking, and instructional quality improvement.
- Supervised teaching teams through classroom observations, mentoring, coaching, and performance feedback processes.
- Designed and facilitated internal training workshops focused on instructional methods, classroom management, and learner assessment approaches.
- Collaborated with school leadership and parents to support student development, behavioural follow-up, and academic performance monitoring.

Selected Evaluation & Consultancy Leadership

- Independent Consultant – Borderless: Developed organizational MEAL and Feedback & Complaint Response Mechanism (FCRM) frameworks, policies, and tools.

- Independent Consultant – NAHNOO: Conducted evaluation of the USAID-funded ROUM Wastewater Management governance intervention.
- Led and supported BMZ, ADH, PRM, NORAD, MSNA, and Municipal Preparedness Risk Assessments across Lebanon and Syria contexts.
- Designed and implemented mixed-method evaluations baseline studies, accountability assessments, and learning reviews for humanitarian and resilience programmes.

Education

- **MBA – Management**, International Lebanese University (2018)
- **BA – English Literature**, Lebanese University (2016)

Certifications

- **Mini MBA – Executive Certificate in Strategic Humanitarian Management**
IABC Media & TAGI Association (2017–2018)
Covered project management, leadership, M&E, TQM, strategic planning, HRM, and ToT. Applied directly to INGO program quality and MEAL leadership.
- Advanced M&E in Complex Contexts – INTRAC (Feb 2026)
- Business & Data Analytics – eCornell (2023)
- Project Design, M&E – PM4DEV (Accredited by PMI)
- Result-Based Monitoring & Evaluation (ELD)
- MEAL DPro – Humentum (2023)

Training & Capacity Building Delivery:

- **CARE Syria (2024–2026):** Facilitated consortium learning events, reflective sessions, and adaptive management processes across operational hubs.
- **CARE Lebanon (2022–2023):** Designed and delivered partner and staff trainings on CHS mainstreaming, indicator design, accountability mechanisms, programme quality, and evaluation ethics.
- **Relief International (2023–2024):** Developed and delivered internal MEAL trainings on baseline design, results frameworks, CHS integration, and evidence use for programme adaptation and proposal development.
- **Lebanese Red Cross (2020–2022):** Facilitated cross-sector trainings on evidence use, reporting consistency, and MEAL systems for emergency programming.
- **SRA Organization, Syria (2019):** Delivered trainings on Monitoring & Evaluation Systems, TQM, and HRM.

Technical Proficiency:

MS Office Suite | Excel/ Power BI | R Studio | Kobo Toolbox | ODK | ONA | LogAlto | Digital Data Collection Systems | Data Visualization & Dashboarding | Information Management (IM) Tools | Quantitative & Qualitative Data Analysis

- **Languages:** Arabic (*native*), English (*fluent*), French (*working knowledge*).